

18-07 为什么回家对我们这么重要？

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Language in the Wild

SOCIAL LIFE

Why Is Going Home So Important to Us?

The history of home teaches us about community and belonging.



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导读

今年过年，你回家么？

为什么过年一定要回家？不论从繁华都市回到小镇乡村，不论跨越南北是否舟车劳顿，“回家过年”就像是刻进中国人骨子里的浪漫：一旦圈出日期、订好车票，内心就是盼望和喜悦，因为对游子而言，回家有着太多意味。

汪曾祺先生描述的“家人闲坐，灯火可亲”，有家可回，这种温暖幸福何尝不是过年最大的要义所在？

下面，让我们一起学习这篇文章：

正文

（加粗：生词难词；红字：固定搭配；色块：语法成分）

主标题：Why Is Going Home So Important to Us?

为什么回家对我们这么重要？

副标题：The history of home teaches us about **community**⁽¹⁾ and **belonging**⁽²⁾.

家的历史教会我们关于“集体感”和“归属感”。

1. community: /kə'mju:nəti/ n. 社区、集体

2. belonging: 英/br'ləŋŋ/ 美/br'ls:ŋŋ/ n. 归属感

① As so many people **head**⁽³⁾ home for the holidays, it **brings up**⁽⁴⁾ the question of exactly what “home” means to us — **not just** why individuals **are willing to brave**⁽⁵⁾ the **perils**⁽⁶⁾ of modern holiday travel to get there, **but also** what the concept⁽⁷⁾ of “home” has meant to us over the history of English.

3. head: /hed/ vi. 奔赴

4. bring up: 提出

5. brave: /breɪv/ vt. 勇敢面对（亦可作形容词）

6. peril: /'perəl/ n. 危险（这里比喻各种困难和挑战）

7. concept: 英/'kɒnsept/ 美/'kɑ:nsept/ n. 概念

随着许多人在假期回家，这引发了一个问题，即“家”对我们究竟意味着什么——为什么人们宁愿面对各种困难和挑战也要回家，以及在英语的历史上，“home”一词的概念对我们意味着什么。



② The homes of history

It is perhaps not that surprising that the word “home” is an old one, **dating back to**⁽⁸⁾ Old English “ham” or “hamum.” A similar word is also found in many languages **related to**⁽⁹⁾ English, such as the German

历史上的家

这也许并不令人惊讶，“home”是一个古老的词汇，可以追溯到古英语的“ham”或“hamum”。类似的词也在许多与英语相关的语言中发现，例如德语的“heim”

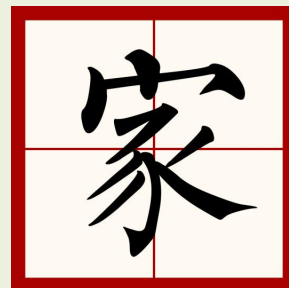
“heim” or the Swedish “hem,” which tells us that it is a very ancient way to talk about where we are from, **predating**⁽¹⁰⁾ English by thousands of years.

8.date back to: 追溯到

9.related to: 跟...相关

10.predate /,pri:'deɪt/ : vt.在日期上早于 (pre+date)

或瑞典语的“hem”，这告诉我们，谈论我们来自哪里是一种非常古老的方式，这比英语本身早了几千年。



③ In the word's earliest use, it **referred** not just **to**⁽¹¹⁾ a single home, but more often⁽¹²⁾ **to** a village or a small **collection**⁽¹³⁾ of **dwellings**⁽¹⁴⁾ that formed a community. This is why many **settlements**⁽¹⁵⁾ during Old English times (in the 6th and 7th centuries) included the word “home” as part of their names — something that was **preserved**⁽¹⁶⁾ in modern place names that have a “ham” ending⁽¹⁷⁾, as in Birmingham or Goodmanham. **In essence**⁽¹⁸⁾, these place names originally meant something like “dwelling place of the Goodman **clan**⁽¹⁹⁾.”

11.refer to: 指

12.more often: 更多、通常

13.collection: /kə'leɪʃ(ə)n/ n.一群、一批

14.dwelling: /'dwelɪŋ/ n.住宅 (动, dwell)

15.settlement: /'set(ə)lmənt/ n.定居点 (settle+ment)

16.preserve: 英/pri'zɜ:v/ 美/pri'zɜ:rv/ vt.保留、保存

17.ending: /'endɪŋ/ n.后缀

18.in essence: 本质上

19.clan: /klæn/ n.宗族

在该词 (home) 最早期的使用中，它不仅指一个家，更多的是指一个村庄或形成了“集体氛围”的小型住宅群。这就是为什么在古英语时代 (6 世纪和 7 世纪) 许多定居点的名称中包含“home”一词——这在现代地名中以词缀 -ham 的形式保留下来，如 Birmingham (伯明翰) 或 Goodmanham。本质上，这些地名最初的意思类似于“古德曼 (Goodman) 家族的居住地”。



④ **Over time**⁽²⁰⁾, this sense of a collective⁽²¹⁾ village dropped **out of use**⁽²²⁾, and the word developed its more **typical**⁽²³⁾ meaning today, of a fixed place where an individual or family **resides**⁽²⁴⁾. However, the idea of belonging and community that the word first **evoked**⁽²⁵⁾ remains in the way that we feel about the places we come from being more than just a matter of⁽²⁶⁾ **geography**⁽²⁷⁾.

随着时间的推移，这种集体村落感消失了，该词发展出了它今天更典型的含义，即个人或家庭居住的固定场所。然而，该词最初所唤起的归属感和社区感仍然保留在我们对老家的感觉中，它不仅仅是个地理概念。

20.over time: 随着时间推移 (=as time goes by)
 21.collective: adj.集体的 (来自 collect)
 22.out of use: 不再使用
 23.typical: /'tɪpɪk(ə)l/ adj.典型的
 24.reside: /rɪ'zɪd/ vi.居住 (名, residence)
 25.evoke: 英/rɪ'vəʊk/ 美/rɪ'vʊk/ vi.唤起
 26.a matter of...: ...的问题
 27.geography: 英/dʒi'ɒɡrəfi/ 美/dʒi'ɑ:ɡrəfi/ n.地理 (形, geographic)



⑤ Where are you from?
 This community sense of home is why, when you ask someone where they are from, most people interpret it as⁽²⁸⁾ a question of **heritage**⁽²⁹⁾ and **identity**⁽³⁰⁾, not just the physical⁽³¹⁾ location where they were born.

你来自哪里?
 “家”的这种集体性内涵在于, 当问某人来自哪里时, 大多数人会从传统和身份的角度来理解这个问题, 而不只是他们出生的地理位置。

28.interpret...as...: 把...理解为...
 29.heritage: /'herɪtɪdʒ/ n.传统 (另, 遗产)
 30.identity: /aɪ'dentəti/ n.身份
 31.physical: /'fɪzɪk(ə)l/ adj.物理的

⑥ For instance, in a study that asked adolescents⁽³³⁾ in Australia to⁽³²⁾ answer the question “Where are you from?” researchers found that out of⁽³⁴⁾ 605 responses⁽³⁵⁾, relatively few simply stated⁽³⁶⁾ a geographic place. Most respondents also added details about why they saw their identity tied to their homeland, ranging from, “I’m from Australia, because it’s where I belong” to⁽³⁷⁾ “Australia, because it is the best place in the world.”

例如, 在一项要求澳大利亚青少年回答“你来自哪里?”的研究中, 研究人员发现在605个回应中, 相对较少的人仅仅指出一个地理位置。大多数回应者还添加了细节, 说明他们为什么认为自己的身份与他们的祖国有关, 例如“我来自澳大利亚, 因为这是我属于的地方”、“澳大利亚, 因为这是世界上最好的地方”。

32.ask...to do: 要求某人做某事
 33.adolescent: /ædə'les(ə)nt/ n.青少年
 34.out of...: 在...中
 35.response: 英/rɪ'spɒns/ 美/rɪ'spɑ:ns/ n.回应 (动, respond; 另, respondent: 答卷人, 调查对象)
 36.state: /steɪt/ vt.陈述
 37.ranging from...to...: 范围从...到...



⑦ The strong **tendency**⁽³⁸⁾ to talk about much more than a physical location in answering the question suggests that “home” is about⁽³⁹⁾ more than geography; it’s about our **psychological**⁽⁴⁰⁾ and emotional

人们在回答这个问题时强烈倾向于不仅仅讨论地理概念, 表明“家”不仅仅是个地理概念; 还是我们对一个地方的心理和情感体验——这种感觉可以回溯到家最初的

experience of a place — something that **harkens back to**⁽⁴¹⁾ its original more **collective** meaning.

38.tendency: /'tendənsi/ n.倾向性（动，tend）

39.be about...: 意义在于...

40.psychological: 英/,saɪkə'lɒdʒɪk(ə)l/

美/,saɪkə'lɑ:dʒɪk(ə)l/ adj.心理上的

41.harken back to...: 回溯到...

更“集体性”的内涵。

⑧ Your **mansion**⁽⁴²⁾ or mine?

While many of us travel back home for the holidays, most of us don't have the good fortune of returning home to a mansion; we simply **inhabit**⁽⁴³⁾ a house. But at one point in time, a house and a mansion meant much the same thing — simply, a **dwelling place**. To understand the **understated**⁽⁴⁴⁾ mansions of our past, we have to **look back at**⁽⁴⁵⁾ the history of Anglo-Norman rule over England starting in the 11th century with the arrival of William the Conqueror⁽⁴⁶⁾.

42.mansion: /'mænj(ə)n/ n.豪宅

43.inhabit: /m'hæbɪt/ vt.居住

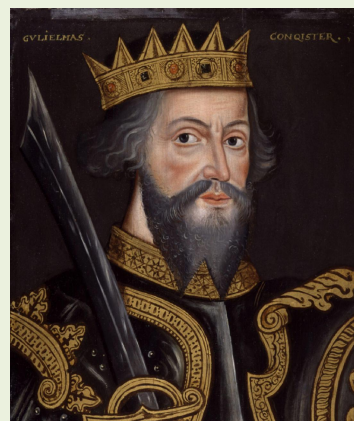
44.understated: 英/ˌʌndə'steɪtɪd/ 美/ˌʌndər'steɪtɪd/ adj.低调的，朴素的

45.look back at: 回顾

46.William the Conqueror: “征服者”威廉（第一位征服英格兰的法国皇帝）

你的豪宅还是我的？

虽然我们很多人都会在假期回家，但大多数人回的只是一个房子（house），而不是一座豪宅（mansion）。但历史上的某个时期，房子（house）和豪宅（mansion）是一样的概念——简单来说，就是一个居住地。要了解历史上不豪（understated）的豪宅（mansion），我们必须回顾 11 世纪随着“征服者威廉”的到来，盎格鲁-诺曼人统治英格兰的历史。



⑨ After the Norman **Invasion**⁽⁴⁷⁾, a **dialect**⁽⁴⁸⁾ of French became the language of government in England for several centuries, which brought a lot of French words, including “maison” (meaning house) into English. This word was from the classical Latin word, “Mansion,” meaning “house” or “dwelling,” and both words were brought into English as **borrowings**⁽⁴⁹⁾ via French after the 12th century.

47.invasion: /m'veɪʒ(ə)n/ n.入侵（动，invade）

48.dialect: /'daɪəlekt/ n.方言

49.borrowing: 英/'bɒrəʊɪŋ/ 美/'bɔ:roʊɪŋ/ n.借用词（borrow+ing）

诺曼征服后，一种法语方言成为了几个世纪以来英格兰的官方语言，这使得许多法语单词进入英语，包括“maison”（房子）。这个词来源于古典拉丁语词“Mansion”，意为“房子”或“住宅”，这两个词在 12 世纪之后作为法语借用词进入英语。

⑩ As often **happened with**⁽⁵⁰⁾ French words when they had **competing**⁽⁵¹⁾ English **counterparts**⁽⁵²⁾ (as in the already existing word “house”), the French word became gradually **associated with**⁽⁵³⁾ the better, grander⁽⁵⁴⁾ version of the thing the native English word described, despite having **started off**⁽⁵⁵⁾ with much the same meaning. So, mansions became the places a Lord lived, and everyone else just lived in **plain**⁽⁵⁶⁾ old houses.

50.happen with...: 发生在...身上

51.competing: /kəm'pi:tɪŋ/ adj.相竞争的、相矛盾的

52.counterpart: 英/'kaʊntəpɑ:t/ 美/'kaʊntəpɑ:rt/ n.对等的人或事物

53.associated with: 与...相关联

54.grand: /grænd/ adj.宏伟的、高高在上的

55.start off: 开始

56.plain: /pleɪn/ adj.朴素的、普通的

当法语单词与现有的英语对应词（如已存在的单词“house”）相矛盾时，法语单词逐渐与本土英语单词所描述的更高级、更宏伟的事物相关联，尽管起初它们的意思非常相似。因此，mansions（豪宅）成为了领主居住的地方，而其他人士只是住在普通的 houses（房子）里。

⑪ A similar process of associated French **fanciness**⁽⁵⁷⁾ explains why we have **dual**⁽⁵⁸⁾ names for animals and animal meat, for instance, pig vs. pork and cow vs. beef. The word **referring to the animal as served**⁽⁵⁹⁾ on a platter⁽⁶⁰⁾ (pork or beef) is typically the French borrowing, often what it was called when being served to the fancy folks by the servants who only talked about pigs and cows among themselves in the kitchen.

57.fanciness: /'fænsɪnəs/ n.高级感（fancy+ness）

58.dual: 英/'dju:əl/ 美/'du:əl/ adj.双重的

59.served: 英/sɜ:vɪd/ 美/sɜ:rɪvd/ adj.被端上桌的（来自动词 serve）

60.platter: 英/'plætə(r)/ 美/'plætər/ n.餐盘

与法语“高级感”相关的类似过程也解释了为什么“动物”和“动物肉类”有着两种名称，例如，“猪”（pig）和“猪肉”（pork）；“牛”（cow）和“牛肉”（beef）。作为盘中餐的动物肉类的单词（pork 或 beef）通常是法语借用词，通常是仆人在为上流人士服务时的叫法，而仆人们在厨房里只用 pig 和 cow 来谈论。



⑫ **Home sweet home**
While maps **pinpoint**⁽⁶¹⁾ geographic spaces, places on a map are much more than **longitude**⁽⁶²⁾ and **latitude**⁽⁶³⁾. Our ideas about what going “home” really means is **bound up with**⁽⁶⁴⁾ a long history as well as **with** our own

家，甜蜜的家

虽然地图标出了地理位置，但地图上的这些地方远不止经度和纬度。回家意味着什么，与悠久的历史以及我们自身的经历和情感连接息息相关。因此，无论你在这个

experiences and connections. So, whether you **are headed to**⁽⁶⁵⁾ a house or a mansion this **season**, the most important thing to remember is that the original meaning of home **centered on**⁽⁶⁶⁾ community—and that is what the holidays should really be about.

节日回到一个房子还是一个豪宅，最重要的是要记住，家最初的含义是以“集体”为中心的——这才是节日真正的意义所在。

61.pinpoint: /'pɪnpɔɪnt/ vt.明确指出，确定 (pin+point)

62.longitude: 英/'lɒŋɡɪtʃu:d/ 美/'lɑ:ndʒɪtu:d/ n.经度

63.latitude: 英/'lætɪtʃu:d/ 美/'læɪtɪtu:d/ n.维度 (海拔: altitude)

64.be bound up with: 与...紧密相连

65.be headed to: 奔赴

66.center on: 以...为中心 (=be centered on)

为什么回家对我们这么重要

一、引子：节日大家回家引出一个问题：家对我们意味着什么 (1)

Introducing the question—what the concept of "home" has meant to us—from the phenomenon of people heading home for the holidays.

二、“home”一词的由来，以及内涵的演变 (2-4)

Origin of the term "home," as well as the evolution of its connotations.

三、“你来自的地方”有何深层次的意味 (5-7)

Deeper significance of "Where are you from?"

四、通过“家”的两个用词——mansion 和 house 的词源比较，折射语言变迁 (8-11)

Comparative analysis of the etymology of the two words for "home"—mansion and house—to reflect language changes.

五、总结：为啥“回家”才是节日的真谛所在 (12)

Conclusion: Why "going home" is what the holidays should really be about.

重点表达中英文例句

1.brave: vt.勇敢面对	<u>brave</u> the wind and the waves 乘风破浪
2.in essence: 本质上	A language is <u>in essence</u> a way of thinking. 语言从本质上来说是一种思维方式。
3.over time: 随着时间推移	<u>Over time</u> , anyone who was once deified will gradually be demystified. 随着时间推移，任何曾经被封神的人，都会一点点祛魅。
4.interpret...as...: 把...理解为...	I don't know whether to <u>interpret</u> your silence <u>as</u> acceptance or refusal. 我不知道该把你的沉默理解为接受还是拒绝。
5.ranging from...to...: 范围从...到...	My father has catholic tastes, <u>ranging from</u> opera, history, <u>to</u> arts. 我父亲兴趣广泛，喜爱戏剧、历史和艺术。
6.be about...: 意义在于	Life isn't about waiting for the storm to pass. It's <u>about</u> learning how to dance in the rain. 生活不是等待暴风雨过去，而是学会在风雨中起舞。
7.harken back to: 回溯到	TV drama Blossoms Shanghai <u>harkens back to</u> an era when China's economy took off. 电视剧《繁花》回溯到中国经济腾飞的那个年代。
8.as 引导非限定性定语从句	He forgot to bring the key, <u>as</u> was often the case. 他忘了带钥匙，这是常事（从句可前可后）。
9.happen with: 发生在...身上	Something similar may <u>happen with</u> anyone of us. 类似的事情会发生在我们中间任何一个人身上。
10.is bound up with: 与...紧密相连、息息相关	An individual's fate <u>is bound up with</u> that of the nation. 个人的命运和国家的命运息息相关。
11.center on: 以...为中心	All work should be <u>centered on</u> economic development. 一切工作应该以经济发展为中心。

典型语法

1. 复杂句式

A similar word is also found in many languages <related to English,> (后置定语) < such as the German “heim” or the Swedish “hem,”> (后置定语) 【which tells us {that <it> (形式主语) is a very ancient way <to talk about [where we are from] (宾语从句) > (真实主语) , [predating English by thousands of years.] (分词做状语) } (宾语从句) 】【(非限定性定语从句)

2. 复杂句式

However, the idea (主语) [of belonging and community <that the word first evoked> (定语从句)] remains (谓语) < in the way> (状语) 【that we feel about the places <we come from> (定语从句) < being more than just a matter of geography.> (后置定语) 】【(定语从句)

3. as 引导非限定性定语从句

【As often happened with French words <when they had competing English counterparts (as in the already existing word “house”)> (时间状语从句) 】【(非限定性定语从句) , the French word became gradually associated with the better, grander version of the thing the native English word described

As often happened with... 这个从句类似这句: As was often the case, he forgot to bring the key. 他忘了带钥匙, 这是常事 (该从句可前可后)。

4. 复杂句式

The word 【referring to the animal <as (it is) served on a platter (pork or beef)> (时间状语从句) 】【(后置定语) is typically <the French borrowing> (表语) , 【often what it was called {when being served to the fancy folks by the servants [who only talked about pigs and cows among themselves in the kitchen.] (定语从句) } (时间状语从句) 】【(同位语)

背景知识点

1. 诺曼征服 (Norman Invasion)

诺曼征服是 1066 年发生在英国的一系列军事行动, 由诺曼底公爵威廉一世 (William the Conqueror) 领导。这场征服以诺曼底军队在哈斯廷斯战役 (Battle of Hastings) 中击败英格兰国王哈罗德二世 (Harold II) 的部队而闻名于世。

诺曼征服的背景可以追溯到英国的王位继承问题。威廉一世声称他有权成为英格兰国王, 理由是英格兰前国王埃德温 (Edward the Confessor) 曾经承诺过王位给他。然而, 当埃德温去世后, 哈罗德二世迅速登上了王位, 并成为英格兰的新国王。这导致了威廉一世率领诺曼底军队入侵英格兰, 试图夺取王位。

1066 年的哈斯廷斯战役是诺曼征服的关键战役。在这场战役中, 哈罗德二世的英格兰军队遭到了诺曼底军队的重创,



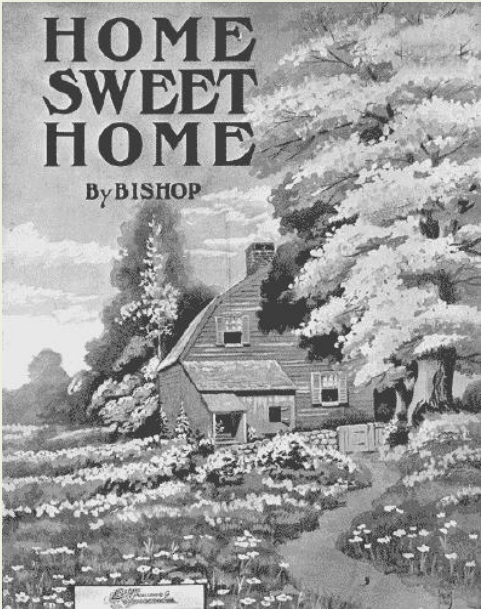
哈罗德二世也在战斗中丧生。威廉一世最终取得了胜利，成为了新的英格兰国王，这标志着诺曼征服的完成。

2. “家，甜蜜的家”（Home, sweet home）

“Home, Sweet Home”是一句流行的英文谚语，形容家是一个舒适、温馨和安全的地方，是人们心灵的避风港，通常用于归家时表达对家的深情和渴望。

在歌曲、诗歌和文学作品中也常引用这句谚语，强调家庭的重要性和对家的眷恋。其中最著名的版本是 19 世纪美国作曲家约翰·霍华德·佩恩（John Howard Payne）的歌曲《Home, Sweet Home》，该歌曲在 19 世纪中叶非常流行，成为了美国内战时期的一首民谣，被广泛认为是家庭、故乡和平安的象征。

无论在哪个文化背景下，“家，甜蜜的家”都是一种普遍的情感表达，强调了家所带来的情感纽带和归属感。它让人们反思和珍视家庭的温暖和快乐，提醒我们家是我们生活中最重要的地方之一，无论身在何处，心永远都在家的方向。



课后练习

一、请用英语回答“课前思考题”

1. “home”这个词是怎么来的？（How did the word “home” come about?）
2. “家”对于我们意味着什么？（What does “home” mean to us?）
- 3.都表示“房子”，mansion 和 house 有何区别？这种区别怎么来的？（How are “mansion” and “house”—both relating to “a dwelling place”—different, and how did this distinction come about?）

二、根据文中重点短语，将下列句子翻译成英文

- 1.随着时间的推移，技术已经改变了我们的交流方式，使信息比以往任何时候都更易获取。
- 2.新智能手机的设计回溯到上世纪九十年代的经典机型，带有一丝怀旧的味道。
- 3.许多发展中国家的经济繁荣与政治稳定息息相关。

三、根据文中重点语法，选择合适的选项

1. The number of senior high school students is increasing, _____ is mentioned above.
A. that B. it C. such D. as
2. _____ is known to everybody, the moon travels round the earth once every month.
A. It B. As C. That D. What

参考答案

一、课前思考题的参考答案

1.The word "home" originates from the Old English "ham" or "hamum," indicating that it is an ancient term predating English by thousands of years and is related to similar words in languages like German ("heim") and Swedish ("hem"). Initially, it referred not just to a single dwelling but often to a village or a small collection of dwellings that formed a community, indicating its deep historical roots in the concept of community and belonging. (home 这个词源自古英语的 ham 或 hamum, 表明它是一个古老的词汇, 早在数千年前就已存在, 并与德语(heim)和瑞典语(hem)等语言中的类似词汇有关。最初, 它并不仅仅指一个单独的住所, 而常常指代一个村庄或一小片集体的住所, 形成了一个社区, 表明它在社区和归属概念上有着深厚的历史根源。)

2."Home" means more than just a physical location or a geographic place; it embodies a sense of heritage, identity, community, and emotional experience. This is evident from how people respond to questions about where they are from, often interpreting it as a question of heritage and identity rather than just the physical location of birth. The concept of "home" is tied to our psychological and emotional experience of a place, harking back to its original, more collective meaning. (“家”不仅仅是一个物理位置或地理地点; 它还体现了一种传统、身份、社区和情感经历的感觉。这可以从人们如何回答关于自己来自哪里的问题中看出, 他们常常将这解读为对传统和身份的问题, 而不仅仅是出生地的物理位置。“家”的概念与我们对一个地方的心理和情感体验紧密相连, 回溯到它最初更集体的含义。)

3.Historically, "house" and "mansion" once meant much the same thing—a dwelling place. However, after the Norman Invasion, the French word "maison" (meaning house) was introduced into English, influencing the language to associate the French borrowing with a better, grander version of what the native English word described. This process led to "mansions" being associated with the grand residences of lords, while "house" referred to the simpler dwellings of the common people. This distinction arose from the influence of French language and culture during the Anglo-Norman rule over England, reflecting a broader trend of French words being used to denote more refined or elevated versions of things. (在历史上, house 和 mansion 曾是一样的概念——居所。然而, 在诺曼征服后, 法语词 maison (意为房子) 被引入英语中, 影响了语言, 使得法语借词与原本的英语词关联起来, 描述更高级、更宏伟的事物。这个过程导致了 mansions 与贵族的宏伟住宅相关联, 而 house 则指的是普通人的简单住所。这种区别源自法语语言和文化在英格兰的盎格鲁-诺曼统治期间的影响, 反映了法语词被用来表示更精致或更高端事物的更广泛趋势。)

二、翻译题的参考答案

1.Over time, technology has transformed the way we communicate, making information more accessible than ever before.

2.The design of the new smartphone harkens back to the classic models of the 1990s, with a nostalgic twist.

3.Economic prosperity is bound up with political stability in many developing nations.

三、选择题的参考答案

1.D 此题为 as 引导非限定性定语从句，意思是“正如”。此处可以换用 which 引导，但意思有别，意为“这一点上面提到了”。

2.B 置于句首时，非限定性定语从句只能用 as 引导，as 在定语从句中作主语。



侃哥陪你读外刊·第18季

逐词逐句 透析外刊

课时	20次课，每次2.5h精讲
内容	回放，朗读，翻译，要点，结构，例句
师资	侃哥亲授
福利	预习+答疑
人群	职场提升、英语爱好